

Destiny unlocked

Videep “Fr4k” Kumar
feedback@skoar.com

What makes a good game? Is it simply a matter of conforming to certain expectations, garnering universal critical acclaim and being a commercial success? Is it about the making of yet another case for the ‘games are art’ argument? What about the triumph of design, or creating a flawless emotion-evoking interactive symphony? Or is it merely sufficient for a game to be ‘fun’, taking that word in its broadest possible meaning? If one were to answer “yes” to that last question, then Bungie’s *Destiny* is certainly most certainly a good game.

There’s an evident emphasis on player-driven plot and ‘meta’ stories, but *Destiny*’s storytelling is so poor, it’s practically nonexistent. It should have been called ‘Endless hours of investment on the part of players in the quest for loot’.

Whether you’re playing through the story, doing patrols, farming loot or dying repeatedly on a Level 24 ‘Strike’ mission, playing with someone else in *Destiny* feels uncomplicated and natural. It’s something that’s made easier by the game’s match-making system which does a super-fast job of not only finding you something to play, but people around your same level to play it with. Competitive multiplayer, on the other hand is largely derivative. Playing matches is only a means to

an end. The absence of private matches or lobby system is also a major issue.

Destiny sports some incredibly satisfying gunplay and there’s some good weapon variety to boot. Guns cover the arsenal that most gamers are familiar with. The game’s Fusion rifles are particularly fun owing to their over-penetration ability, allowing you to take out multiple foes at once. Weapons such as the Hand Cannon, for instance, help you score satisfying headshots thanks in no small part to the not-so-subtle auto aim that ensures that you get more than your fair share of critical hits. And in typical Bungie style, melee attacks pack a punch worthy of Master Chief himself. Uncommon, Rare and Legendary weapons can be found/purchased and upgraded later in the game as you gain experience points as well.

There’s no complex number crunching at play in *Destiny*—as you level up your character, playing as one of three classes, the Titan, Hunter or Warlock, you unlock unique abilities and get better gear in the form of loot drops (or you could purchase them at various vendors in the Tower) which will help you tackle the next harder mission. Each class features a sub class—both sub classes sport distinct abilities and need to be levelled up separately. Bungie has absolutely nailed the pace of character progression in addition to loot drop frequency and difficulty scaling. There’s always just enough to keep you coming back for more. Grinding for weapons, armour and loot is an abso-

lute essential, and as a result, gameplay is very repetitive. Expect to traverse familiar areas and combat familiar foes more than once to get your loot fix. As the endgame approaches and you hit level cap, the quest for loot is pretty much all you’ll be doing when you’re partaking in a high level Strike or Raid.

From locales to weapon and character design, *Destiny* is an absolute visual feast. The idea to use real planets such as Mars and Venus rather than nonexistent sci-fi planet names seems to have paid off too.

A really disappointing aspect of *Destiny* is the voice acting of the non-player characters. Despite sporting names such as Peter Dinklage (*Game of Thrones*), Nathan Fillion (*Firefly*, *Castle*) and Lance Reddick (*The Wire*, *Fringe*), *Destiny*’s citizens come off as shockingly lifeless. The nonexistent story and poorly fleshed out characters accompanied by monotonous dialogue delivery make for some of the drabest voice acting you’ll hear in a game.

Verdict

Destiny’s strong gunplay and near-perfect co-op and loot will keep you hooked, but decent solo play and PvP might ruin it for some of you. 

MOAR!

Developer: Bungie
Genre: Action RPG, FPS
Price: ₹3,999 to ₹4,299
Publisher: Activision

